

ESDS launches cloud data centre in Mumbai

ESDS (Exuberant Support for Data Services) has launched its second data centre in Mumbai. The Uptime Institute certified cloud data centre is a part of the company's MoU inked with the government of Maharashtra, involving an investment of ₹ 2 billion.

Spread over 7432sqm (80,000 square feet), the new data centre is located in Mahape, Navi Mumbai, and will help ESDS create 500 employment opportunities in 2017-18. It offers private cloud solutions as well as the proprietary eNLight Public cloud hosting service to customers.

"Maharashtra has always been among the leading destinations providing quality infrastructure to companies and creating employment opportunities, especially in the IT sector. Additionally, the country needs innovative technology solutions like the ESDS patented cloud and data centres to accelerate businesses in today's digital economy," said Devendra Fadnavis, CM, Maharashtra, in a statement.

In addition to the launch of the new cloud data centre, ESDS has released its eNLight 360 hybrid cloud platform. This new offering is designed to offer large enterprises as well as SMEs an auto-scalable and pay-per-consume cloud hosting solution. Moreover, the new platform can be used to roll out the firm's SaaS, PaaS and IaaS based portfolio.

"Our new cloud data centre and eNLight 360 on-premise hybrid cloud platform is a true testimony of our commitment to constantly innovate and raise industry benchmarks," ESDS CEO and MD, Piyush Somani, said in a statement.

With the new development, ESDS' overall data centre footprint is now raised to over 9290.304sqm (100,000 square feet) of floor space across Mumbai and Nashik. Currently, the eNLight Cloud has a total of 300 enterprise clients in the BFSI, government, retail and education sectors.

Microsoft organises an open source conference!

Microsoft organised its first open source conference in India, the 'Microsoft Openness Days', on March 21, 2016, at Hyderabad.

The aim of the conference was to assist 1,000 architects, developers and cloud professionals in discovering and leveraging Microsoft's Azure cloud platform for government and enterprise solutions, a statement issued by Microsoft mentioned.

The conference included the 'Open Hack' event, which was India's first open source hackathon on Azure by Microsoft. It had the support of the Telangana government. The hackathon was on for six hours, and gave developers the option of working on and showcasing innovative applications and solution ideas based on the state government's digital initiatives.

According to Jayesh Ranjan, secretary, Department of IT, Electronics and Communications, Telangana government, "We are a firm supporter of technology to drive Telangana's growth and development. We are very pleased to partner with Microsoft to host the Open Hack in our state."

Microsoft and T-Hub will be selecting the top six apps and teams for further development, and mentoring to the stage of market readiness. The winners were

New York bill proposes to offer tax credits to open source contributors

Over several years, the open source software community has given three distinct meanings to the term 'free'.

These are:

- Software that can be utilised or changed as per the user's needs and wishes
- Software that is available at no cost
- Software that has no recurring costs

However, the development of open source software does involve some costs. Many developers pay for extra hardware to test or host code, websites, etc. Currently, there is a bill under consideration with the New York Senate that offers to offset these costs, and is sponsored by Senator Daniel Squadron and co-sponsored by Senator Ruth Hassell-Thompson.

The bill endeavours to offer a tax credit of 20 per cent of "expenses associated with the development of open source and free software" with an annual maximum limit of US\$ 200. The bill is based on a report by the Centre for American Progress and is the first of its kind to be introduced to a state legislature. The bill aims at promoting innovation.

According to the GM of Open Source Initiative (OSI), Patrick Masson, the OSI offered guidance on factual matters relating to open source and free software. He said that the senators' offices wished to ensure consistency in evaluation by government/state officials. This is in continuation to internationally recognised standards of the software industry, and to prevent ambiguity among projects that may call themselves open source but are not in compliance with the Open Source Definition.

There have been several variants of this bill which had been introduced previously and not been passed. Part of the challenge lies in getting a legislative body to understand technology issues.



Cloud Data Service